



MOST ATTACKING BATTERS IN FRANCHISE CRICKET SEEM TO CURB THEIR INSTINCTS WHEN THEY TURN OUT IN NATIONAL COLOURS ON THE GLOBAL STAGE

From rule innovations to conditions and reduced margin for errors, here is a deep dive into how and why international T20 cricket, particularly World Cups, may not be keeping pace with the stratospheric standards set by franchise leagues and that there may still be a place under the sun for style and finesse.

What do the data tell us?

There has been a stark contrast in the strike rates of batters across the IPL and the T20 World Cup (See **Graph 1 on page 22**). In the IPL, the strike rates have generally shown an

On the speed dial: Travis Head provided blazing starts for Sunrisers Hyderabad in IPL 2024, even though his form dipped towards the business end of the tournament. It will be interesting to see whether he will go for the kill right from the get-go this T20 World Cup. EMMANUAL YOGINI

upward trend over the years, with occasional fluctuations. One major dip in strike rate was during the 2009 edition, which was moved to South Africa due to a clash with the Indian general elections.

The second drop from the trend was during the 2021 season, which was held in the United Arab Emirates following the onset of the COVID-19 pandemic the previous year.

Conversely, in T20 World Cups, the strike rates have shown more variability, with no consistent upward or downward trend.

The lowest strike rate recorded during the T20 World Cup was in the 2021 edition held in the UAE. Since the IPL held here in the same year shows a drop in tournament strike rate too, the conditions at the venues could have been the major factor